

Running the portal



CF Building Approvals — office admin guide (/admin)

Sign in at the portal address + /admin with the staff passcode · Updated August 2026

THE ADMIN FRONT PAGE, TOP TO BOTTOM

1 Sync health banner

Green = last sync ran inside the hour, all good. **Amber "stale"** = no sync for over an hour — check the incident card. **Red "failed"** = the error is printed in the banner. Below it, any **unmatched Monday clients** are listed: those cards' jobs and messages reach nobody until matched. Fix each with the dropdown ("add as alias to...") or *New client* — one click, done on the next sync.

2 Portal pages (the on/off switches)

Turn a client section off while you update it — the link vanishes, the page shows "temporarily unavailable", and the matching actions pause. Flip it back when done. No deploy needed; takes effect on next page load.

3 Info sheets & Council forms

Upload a PDF to **supersede a guidance note** (clients get the new version instantly; Revert restores the original), or to host the current **BA1/BA2/BA5/BA13/BA19/BA22** under Resources. When the Building Commission revises a form, replacing it here takes ten seconds.

4 Submission queue (usually empty)

Lodgements go straight onto the board. A lodgement only waits here if Monday couldn't be reached when it was submitted — Accept sends it on. If the queue keeps filling, Monday or its token is the problem.

5 Run sync

Forces the 5-minute cycle to run now — useful when a client's on the phone. The result line shows jobs, files, messages and anything unmatched.

CLIENTS & LOGINS

- ✓ **Add a client** — name as it appears in Monday's Client column (suffixes and brackets are ignored automatically); their email if the board carries it — an email match attaches jobs regardless of spelling; other spellings as aliases.
- ✓ **Issue a login** — username plus an optional **person's name** (their messages then show "Joe, Ventura Homes"). The one-time setup code appears once — pass it on straight away; it expires in 30 days.
- ✓ **"I can't log in"** — click their username to **reset**: a new setup code is issued and their old password keeps working until they use it. Clients can also self-serve with *Forgot password?* — a code goes to the email we hold.
- ✓ **Check folders** — per client, confirms the portal can resolve their SharePoint Issued folders.

REPORTS AND THE ACTIVITY LOG

- ✓ **Reports** — issued counts, the *actual* median turnaround in business days against the 3–4 we publish, and busiest clients. If the median creeps above the published figure, either the process or the promise needs adjusting — the page flags it.
- ✓ **Activity log** — the append-only record: accepts, rejects, logins issued/reset, client matches, certificate downloads (with who). This is what a complaint, insurer or Building Services Board query asks for — it fills itself.

THE MESSAGES RULES — WORTH KNOWING COLD

- ✓ An update starting `FIR:` or `CLIENT:` goes to the client — portal thread *and* email. **Anything else stays internal.** Never start an internal note with either prefix.
- ✓ `FIR:` then a **shortcut** writes the whole request for you — `FIR: Soil Class`. Several at once (`FIR: Soil Class, Elevations`) come out as one message with numbered items. The card gets a note back saying what went. **Admin** → **FIR Library** has all of them, and you can reword any of them.
- ✓ A shortcut with a letter wrong — `Soil Class` — sends *nothing* and puts a "did you mean" note on the card. Same for a shortcut you've switched off, and for a lone word that isn't one. Nothing reaches a client unless a shortcut matched exactly, or you wrote a real sentence.
- ✓ `CLIENT:` never expands. It is always literal.
- ✓ Works on a card in any active status; completed/cancelled cards aren't scanned.
- ✓ When a client replies, the office gets an email — you never need to watch the board for replies.
- ✓ Files you attach to a Monday update do *not* reach the client — put requests in words. (Sending documents to clients is a future feature.)

AMENDMENTS — NEVER ON THE BOARD

- ✓ An amendment **does not open a Monday card**. It emails whoever is in the card's **Certified By** column, with the office copied — or Rebecca when that column is empty. Chris or Rebecca replies "yes" by email, exactly as before.
- ✓ The one new step is Kacie's: watermark and re-issue as usual, then upload the revised certificate on **Admin** → **Amendments**. With no card there's no SharePoint sync to collect it.
- ✓ The original card gets *one* note. No new item, no status, no invoice.
- ✓ Set the routing first — **Settings** → **Amendments**, then **Rebuild Now** on the Amendments page. Until both are done a lodged amendment sits there silently and the client thinks it's with us.
- ✓ Because they're off the board, the board can't notice one going quiet. The 5pm report does. If you get an amendment email that isn't yours, say so rather than leaving it.

TEAMS

Settings → Teams. The same items as the 5pm report, as they happen, into a channel. Off by default and safe to mute — nothing depends on it, and the report still runs.

SWITCHES THAT LIVE IN VERCEL (NOT /ADMIN)

AUTO_ACCEPT_LODGEMENTS	Default on. Set 0 to make every lodgement wait in the review queue for a human Accept.
DIGEST_ENABLED	Default off. Set 1 to send every builder a Monday-morning summary of their active jobs, with a "with you" section that chases FIRs automatically.
RETENTION_MONTHS	How long downloaded packages stay before the files purge. Currently 3.
OFFICE_EMAIL	Where client-reply notifications land. Keep it a watched inbox.

Changing a Vercel variable does nothing until the project is **redeployed** — Deployments → ... → Redeploy.

WEEKLY TWO-MINUTE SWEEP

- Sync banner green?
- Unmatched list empty — or matched with one click?
- Submission queue empty?
- Reports: median turnaround still inside the published 3–4 days?
- Any new Monday status labels created this week? Tell Chris so the portal's wording map stays complete.
- Amendments page: anything sitting in Waiting more than a couple of days?
- Any "did you mean" notes on cards this week — someone reaching for a shortcut we don't have? Worth adding it.

The two calendar reminders that matter: the Microsoft Graph client secret (expires ~July 2028 — six weeks' warning is set; an expired secret silently stops files, folders and email) and the Monday API token if its owner's account ever changes.